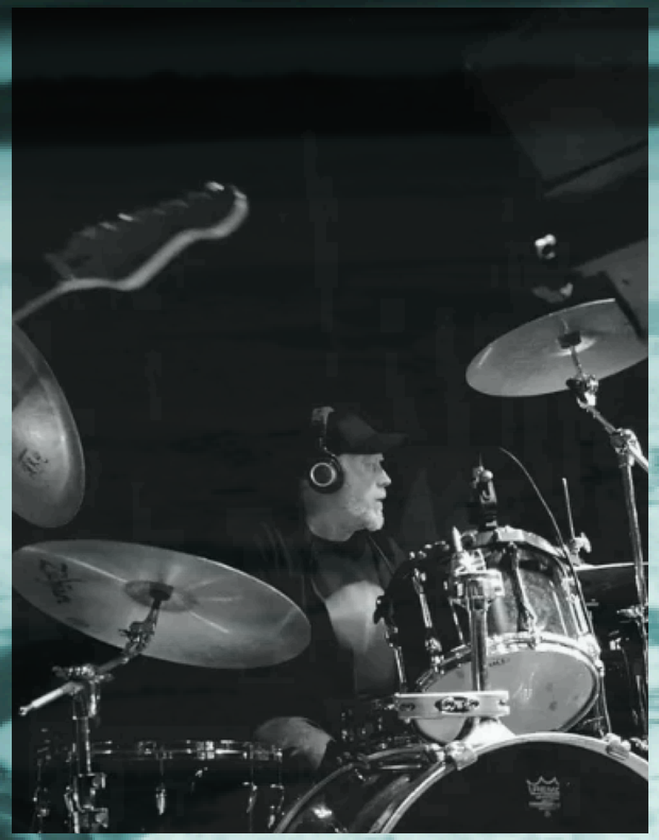
STARS AND THE UNDERGROUND

Post-Punk, Shoegaze and Dark Synthwave from New Zealand







booking: duskaotearoa@gmail.com

https://linktr.ee/satu.co.nz

STARS AND THE UNDERGROUND

-BIO

Stars and the Underground is the musical project of Auckland, New Zealand based singer songwriter John Mason.

Formed in 2019, the band has released an EP "Evolution Circle" and two singles to date, "Nosferatu Upon Tyne" (2020) and "Lonely Black Hearts" (2025) both to critical acclaim.

Now a new single "Echolocation" featuring Hannah Berry (Talmar) on vocals (2026) has been released.

The band is also currently working on their debut album "Guardians of the Night" to be released in 2027.

The band has performed live in New Zealand and Australia with a variety of line ups and guest musicians and with international bands including Drab Majesty(US), Ikon and Sounds Like Winter(AU) and online for the World Goth Day Festival 2025 w/Frenchy and the Punk(US) , Stella Wembley(UK), Bellhead(US).

Stars and the Underground's music is a blend of Post-Punk, Shoegaze and Dark Synthwave with our own ethereal and gritty textures with a "Kiwi" flavour.

The current line up:

John Mason
(Vocals/Guitar)
ex Winterland NZ

John McDermott
(Drums/Production)
ex Headless Chickens

Hannah Berry
Vocals/Keyboards)
Talmar

STARS AND THE UNDERGROUND -RELEASES

Echolocation
Single
May 22nd, 2026



Tracklist:
1. Echolocation

Performed By:
Mason, McDermott, Berry

Recorded and Mixed
and Mastered By:
John McDermott
@Arch Hill Studios,
Auckland

Lonely Black Hearts
Single
April 1st, 2025

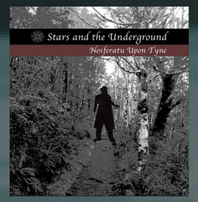


Tracklist:
1. Lonely Black Hearts
2. Lonely Black Hearts
(Robots In Love Remix)
3. Lonely Black Hearts
(Action Ant Remix)

Performed By:
Mason, McDermott

Recorded and Mixed
and Mastered By:
John McDermott
@ Arch Hill Studios,
Auckland

Nosferatu Upon Tyne
Single
August 12, 2020



Tracklist:
1. Nosferatu Upon Tyne
2. Nosferatu Upon Tyne
(Robots In Love Remix)

Performed By:
Mason, McDermott, Veen
Kimber-Manufui

Recorded and Mixed
and Mastered By:
John McDermott
@ Arch Hill Studios,
Auckland

Included on:
UnObscured
Comp Vol 2 2020

Evolution Circle EP
EP
June 1, 2019



Tracklist:
1. Echolocation
2. Have a Heart
3. Twilight by Design
4. Quiet Remix
(By Ashes the Condition)

Written & Performed By:
Mason, O'Kane Connolly,
Wallbank

Recorded and Mixed By:
Darryn Harkness
Produced By:
Darryn Harkness

STARS AND THE UNDERGROUND

-SHOWS

Date	Lineup	Venue	Location
March 4th 2027	w/Breaches, General Kala, Talmar	Whammy Bar	Auckland, NZ
Dec 5th 2026	w/Sisters Of Mercy(UK)	Powerstation	Auckland, NZ
Oct 2026	w/We Will Ride Fast	Whammy Public Bar	Auckland, NZ
May 2026	World Goth Day Festival	Online Event	Bloomington, Indiana, USA
Sept 2025	w/Robots In Love, Breaches	Voodoo Lounge	Tauranga, NZ
Sept 2025	w/Robots In Love, Breaches	Ding Dong Lounge	Auckland, NZ
Jul 2025	w/The Liers	Claire Inn	Auckland, NZ
Jun 2025	Goth Night	Ding Dong Lounge	Auckland, NZ
Apr 2025	w/Other Voices	Whammy Bar	Auckland, NZ

STARS AND THE UNDERGROUND -PRESS & LINKS

"Echolocation is, without a doubt, an immersive, ethereal, and atmospheric sonic journey, where coldness and emotion coexist in perfect tension..."
— Ignacio, Indie Valley Music (https://indievalleymusic.com/) Chile

"Are you already familiar with Stars and the Underground? You should be, especially if you're addicted to the dark sounds within the shoegaze genre, or to the ethereal and dreamlike bursts hidden in the most refined modern post-punk..."
— Sound & Vision (https://svmusica.com/) Mexico

"From New Zealand comes a gorgeous slice of shoegaze, post-punk band Stars and the Underground have dropped their single Echolocation and its drenched in that dreamy, hazy guitar sound. Theres a special guest too Hannah Berry of the band Talmar lends her vocals to the track. Its lush, its atmosphere and its perfect for losing youself in..."
— Side-Line Magazine (https://www.side-line.com) Belgium

"Stars and the Underground conjure a dark synthwave and shoegaze sound that drifts like cathedral smoke and sways like twilight on the tide. Guitars chime and shimmer with celestial clarity, while basslines brood beneath, steady as sleepwalks. Vocals echo like lost prayers, half-whispered, half-resolved. Drawing from the same windswept well as The Church and The Mission, they summon atmosphere over aggression, beauty over bombast, mood over momentum..."
— Alice Teeple, Post-Punk.com

"After a two-year silence, Stars and the Underground are back—louder, darker, and more cinematic than ever. Their new single 'Lonely Black Hearts' marks the first taste of their upcoming album Guardians of the Night, a brooding blend of post-punk, synthwave, and shoegaze that's already turning heads internationally..."
— Nick, EmptySpaces.co.nz

"Dark Soulful Post Punk from New Zealand..."
— Mick Mercer (UK), the longest running Goth and Post-Punk writer in the world.

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